

C17 B RESPONSIBLE LABOR PRACTICES | O (MAX : 3 PT)

Intent : Promote organizational commitment to responsible labor practices in order to address modern slavery in the supply chain and support human rights.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to evaluate and disclose unfair labor practices associated with modern slavery in their operations and supply chain, specifically in the areas of construction, cleaning and catering, and to take steps to address modern slavery in the supply chain.

Issue : Modern slavery refers to the various situations in which a person is recruited, transported or compelled to work through force, fraud or coercion.^{1,2} Modern slavery practices may include traditional slavery (or involuntary servitude), human trafficking, forced labor, bonded labor, sex trafficking and the worst forms of child labor.^{1,2} The Global Slavery Index estimates that in 2016 there were over 40 million victims of modern slavery worldwide, including 24.9 million in forced labor.³ Modern slavery is recognized as a violation of human rights, including a right to health, and as a global public health issue.⁴⁻⁷ Research shows modern slavery has severe consequences for victim health and well-being, including high risk of physical injury, mental health issues like anxiety, depression and post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD), exposure to infectious disease, suicide and limited access to healthcare.⁴⁻⁷ Reports estimate that a majority of modern slavery victims – nearly 30 million – reside in the Asia Pacific region, where many global supply chains lead.⁸⁻¹⁰ Of the 195 countries in the world, only 40 have investigated labor exploitation in supply chains and almost half of all countries worldwide have yet to criminalize slavery.^{11,12} Industries found to be at highest risk for modern slavery include clothing, electronics and technology manufacturing, food and agriculture (including catering), and construction.^{13,14} The cleaning sector is also considered high-risk given the complexity and opaque operations of the industry; in 2011, the Fair Work Ombudsman (FWO) reported that out of 315 Australian cleaning companies analysed, 37.1% were non-compliant with responsible labor practices, including underpayment of wages and lack of recordkeeping.^{14,15} Businesses often do not sufficiently assess modern slavery risks in their supply chains due to the complexity of supply chains reaching across sectors and regions; for example, in 2016 only 47% of UK manufacturers had adequately identified all of the suppliers in their supply chain.^{13,14}

Solutions : Businesses can play a critical role in helping to identify and prevent occurrences of modern slavery.¹⁶ To address modern slavery in the supply chain, companies must first establish due diligence processes that comprehensively detect risks and influencing conditions.¹⁴ The UK Modern Slavery Act of 2015 requires companies to establish and disclose a risk assessment process, anti-slavery policies and steps taken to address identified risks.¹⁷ The Australian Modern Slavery Act of 2018 similarly requires entities to publish an annual report on actions they have taken to address modern slavery in their operations and supply chains.¹⁸ Best practices also include ethical procurement policies, employee training on relevant policies and risk identification as well as engagement with Tier 1 suppliers and established processes for incident reporting, while “leadership” approaches include standalone modern slavery or human rights policies, deeper risk assessments into Tier 2 suppliers through Tier 6 suppliers, capability-building with suppliers, strong remediation mechanisms and slavery-specific performance metrics.^{13,19} Implementing these steps also supports the achievement of U.N. Sustainable Development Goal 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth, which calls for eradicating forced labor, modern slavery, human trafficking and child labor by 2025.²⁰

PART 1 DISCLOSE LABOR PRACTICES (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

The project or organization meets the following requirements:

- a. A comprehensive mapping of the project’s or organization’s structure, operations and supply chains is conducted annually for Tier 1 suppliers in the following sectors (as applicable):²¹
 1. Construction.
 2. Cleaning.
 3. Catering.
 4. Security.
 5. Maintenance.
- b. A risk assessment is conducted annually that evaluates risks in the project’s or organization’s operations and Tier 1 suppliers (at a minimum) in the above sectors for the following practices associated with modern slavery:^{21,22}
 1. Worst forms of child labor.
 2. Forced labor.
 3. Traditional slavery.
 4. Bonded labor.
 5. Human trafficking.
- c. A report is completed annually that discloses the following information, is reviewed by executives in the C-Suite, board of directors and/or equivalent high-level stakeholders, and published on the project or organization’s website:²²
 1. Processes of evaluation and risk assessment.
 2. Results of evaluation or risk assessment, including where modern slavery risks have been identified.
 3. Statement of commitment (including established goals and policies) aimed at identifying, preventing and mitigating modern slavery practices in the project’s or organization’s operations and supply chain.

Note : This feature is a beta strategy and has an additional documentation requirement (beta feature feedback form). The feedback form supports IWBI in developing new features that are effective and applicable to projects around the world.

PART 2 IMPLEMENT RESPONSIBLE LABOR PRACTICES (MAX : 2 PT)

Note : Projects may only achieve this part if Part 1 is also achieved.

For All Spaces:

The project or organization implements an action plan that meets the following requirements:^{21,22}

- a. Establishes annual targets for the prevention and/or mitigation of modern slavery in their operations and supply chain in the following areas (as applicable):
 1. Construction.

2. Cleaning.
 3. Catering.
 4. Security.
 5. Maintenance.
- b. Describes how the effectiveness of the implemented strategies are assessed annually and updates targets and/or strategies accordingly.²¹
- c. Addresses implementation of the following strategies to meet established targets:^{21,22}
1. Anti-slavery and anti-human trafficking policies.
 2. Responsible procurement policies.
 3. Annual trainings, mandatory for employees involved in procurement and made available to all employees, educating about the consequences of modern slavery and the project or organization's policies and steps for preventing, identifying and reporting observed or potential incidences of modern slavery practices.
 4. Reporting protocol that allows employees and supply chain Tier 1 suppliers to anonymously report modern slavery risks and practices.
 5. Process for review and remediation of any identified modern slavery practices to prevent and mitigate future incidents.
 6. Process for consultation and revision of contracts, including establishing supplier obligations to address modern slavery, with any suppliers that have been identified as high risk for modern slavery practices.
- d. The requirements in a, b and c are met for supply chain Tiers according to the table below.

Feature Tier	Supplier Level	Point Value
1	Supply Chain Tier 1	1 point
2	At least Supply Chain Tiers 1 & 2	2 points

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